

What is the Super Bowl?

This Sunday, February 9, is not a holiday in the United States, but it might seem like one to Americans.

Many will be attending parties to watch Super Bowl LIX. The Super Bowl is the championship game of professional American football.

The National Football League, or NFL, has 32 teams mainly based in large cities across the U.S.

The first professional league was formed in 1920, when representatives of four teams met in Canton, Ohio. The group first called itself the American Professional Football Association but changed the name two years later to the National Football League.

In 1960, Texas businessman Lamar Hunt pushed the effort to create the American Football League, or AFL. The two leagues competed with each other to sign top football players from universities around the country.

In 1965, established NFL players began negotiating to play for the competing league. So, officials of the two leagues decided to work together. This agreement established a championship game between the two leagues. It was officially called the AFL-NFL World Championship Game but became known as the Super Bowl.

The first Super Bowl was played in 1967 in Los Angeles, California. The Green Bay Packers defeated the Kansas City Chiefs. It was not a very exciting game. Many of the seats in the sports center were empty. That changed with the Super Bowl played two years later. Experts say the public finally accepted the new league when the New York Jets defeated the Baltimore Colts.

After that game in 1969, officials of the two leagues decided to create a new National Football League. They divided the teams into two competing conferences, the American Conference, or AFC, and the National Conference, NFC. Each year, the conference champions play in the Super Bowl.

Today, the Super Bowl is a major sporting event. Tens of thousands of people will be watching the game Sunday at the Superdome in New Orleans, Louisiana.

Tens of millions of other people around the world will be watching Super Bowl LIX. They will be watching to see if the AFC Kansas City Chiefs or the NFC Philadelphia Eagles become the champions of American football.

Both teams have had success in the Big Game. The Eagles are one-time NFL champions. They defeated the New England Patriots in Super Bowl LII. This Sunday will be the team's fifth NFL

championship game appearance.

The Kansas City Chiefs have played for the championship six times. They have won four times, including the last two Super Bowls. The Chiefs are the first team in NFL history to have a chance to win a third Super Bowl in a row.

I'm Caty Weaver.

Caty Weaver wrote this report for VOA Learning English with contributing information from the Associated Press.

Vocabulary

league - n. สมาคมกีฬา

exciting - adj. น่าตื่นเต้น

in a row - phrase. ติดต่อกัน

Reading Comprehension Quiz

1. According to the article, what is special about February 9th in the United States, even though it is not an official public holiday?

- A) It marks the beginning of a long weekend for many workers.
- B) Many Americans treat it as a significant social event.
- C) Schools and businesses are often closed on this day.
- D) It is a traditional day for national remembrance.

2. What is the primary activity many Americans will engage in on February 9th, as mentioned in the text?

- A) Participating in a national parade.
- B) Attending Super Bowl parties.
- C) Visiting historical landmarks.
- D) Celebrating a religious festival.

3. The Super Bowl is described as the championship game for which sport?

- A) Professional American baseball.
- B) Professional American basketball.
- C) Professional American football.
- D) Professional American soccer.

4. How many teams constitute the National Football League (NFL)?

- A) 24 teams.
- B) 30 teams.
- C) 32 teams.
- D) 40 teams.

5. In what year was the first professional football league established?

- A) 1922.
- B) 1920.
- C) 1960.
- D) 1965.

6. What was the initial name of the organization that eventually became the National Football League?

- A) The Canton Football Alliance.
- B) The American Professional Football Association.
- C) The National Football Alliance.
- D) The United States Football League.

7. Who was instrumental in founding the American Football League (AFL)?

- A) Lamar Hunt.
- B) Caty Weaver.
- C) A group of NFL players.
- D) Officials from Canton, Ohio.

8. What was the primary way the NFL and AFL competed with each other after the AFL's creation?

- A) By hosting joint championship games.
- B) By merging their organizational structures.
- C) By negotiating player salaries for existing teams.
- D) By recruiting top players from universities.

9. What development in 1965 led the NFL and AFL officials to cooperate?

- A) A decrease in public interest in football.
- B) Players from the NFL seeking to join the AFL.
- C) Financial difficulties faced by both leagues.
- D) A desire to expand into international markets.

10. What was the original formal title of the game that eventually became known as the Super Bowl?

- A) The American Football Championship.
- B) The NFL-AFL Unity Bowl.
- C) The AFL-NFL World Championship Game.
- D) The Professional Football Super Classic.

11. Where and when did the inaugural Super Bowl take place?

- A) New Orleans in 1969.
- B) Los Angeles in 1967.
- C) Canton, Ohio in 1920.
- D) Baltimore in 1969.

12. According to experts, what specific game led to the public's widespread acceptance of the new football league?

- A) The first Super Bowl between the Packers and Chiefs.
- B) The game where the New York Jets defeated the Baltimore Colts.
- C) Any game played in the 1960 season.
- D) A match involving Lamar Hunt's team.

13. Following the 1969 game, how was the National Football League restructured?

- A) It merged with several smaller regional leagues.
- B) It was dissolved and replaced by the AFL.
- C) It was divided into two competing conferences.
- D) It introduced a new international division.

14. Approximately how many people are projected to watch Super Bowl LIX globally?

- A) Tens of thousands.
- B) Hundreds of thousands.
- C) Tens of millions.
- D) Hundreds of millions.

15. What historical achievement could the Kansas City Chiefs accomplish if they win Super Bowl LIX?

- A) Win their first-ever Super Bowl title.
- B) Tie the record for most Super Bowl wins by any team.
- C) Become the first team to win three Super Bowls consecutively.

D) Surpass the Eagles in total Super Bowl appearances.